

VAX POPULI
Covishield vials at the Pune premises of the Serum Institute of India

GETTY IMAGES

BIOTECH MILESTONES

1978
India's first biotech firm, a private initiative, **Biocon is founded** in Bengaluru

1981
Council for Scientific and Industrial Research opens **Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology** in Hyderabad

1984
Institute for Microbial Technology set up in Chandigarh

1986
GoI institutes **Department of Biotechnology** (DBT)

1994
Syngene, our first contract research organisation, begins R&D services

1997
Centre for Biological Technology (CBT) set up to focus on genomics and bioinformatics

1998
Monsanto Research opens **R&D centre to grow Bt cotton**; DBT approves Mahyco Monsanto to grow Bt cotton

2007
National Biotechnology Development Strategy launched; biotech park opens in Lucknow

2009
National Biotechnology Regulatory Authority Bill introduced; Biotechnology Industry Partnership Programme launched

2010
Cadila Healthcare, Serum Institute of India and Bharat Biotech launch **first H1N1 swine flu vaccine**

2011
Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC) set up

2012
India ranked 12th in the world in biotech and third largest in the Asia Pacific region, after Japan and Korea

2013
India becomes biggest producer of **Hepatitis B recombinant vaccine**

2015
DBT launches NBDS-II, a five-year programme to turn India into a biotech hub

2016
Regional Centre for Biotechnology Bill adopted; National Intellectual Property Rights policy launched; BIRAC invites proposals for inventions and ideas under Biotechnology Ignition Grant (BIG)

2018
Malaysia awards Biocon **$68.43 mn contract** to supply recombinant human insulin formulations for three years

2020
BioEconomy's contribution to GDP is recorded at 2.7 per cent